

Word family: **budge / budges / budged / budging / unbudging**

Base word: budge

Past tense: budged

Past participle: budged

-ing form: budging

Related form: unbudging

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “My hands got covered in grease, some of the screws would not **budge**, and the whole process felt as slow as watching paint dry.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **budge** means to **move even a very small amount from a fixed position**, especially when something is difficult or impossible to move.

繁體中文： **稍微移動；挪動；尤指原本卡住或固定的東西終於移動一點**

中文翻譯：

> “...some of the screws would not **budge**...”

「.....有些螺絲怎樣也**扭不動 / 紋絲不動**.....」

Here:

would not budge = 完全動不了；怎樣用力也移動不了

1. **budge = move slightly from a fixed position (物理移動) — 移動一點；挪動**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To move, or make something move, even a small distance from its current position.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Some of the screws would not **budge**.”

「有些螺絲怎樣也**扭不動**。」

Practice 2

> “The cupboard was so heavy that it would not **budge**.”

「那個櫃太重了，怎樣也**搬不動 / 紋絲不動**。」

Practice 3

> “I pushed the door, but it barely **budged**.”

「我推了那扇門，但它幾乎**一動也不動**。」

budge = 從原來固定的位置稍微移動，常用於強調某物很難移動

Very common patterns:

- * won't budge
- * wouldn't budge
- * barely budged
- * refuse to budge

This verb is especially common in **negative constructions**.

2. **budge** = change your opinion/position (立場) — 改變立場；讓步

Budge can figuratively mean changing an opinion, decision, demand, or position.

Practice 4

> “He refused to **budge** on the issue.”

「他在這個問題上拒絕**改變立場 / 讓步**。」

Practice 5

> “Neither side was willing to **budge**.”

「雙方都不願意**讓步**。」

budge = 原本堅持某個立場、決定或要求，之後稍微改變或作出讓步

The metaphor is straightforward:

> physically refuse to move → figuratively refuse to move from a position

This is a genuinely useful figurative branch.

3. **budge = change in level, amount, price, etc. (數值 / 情況) — 改變 ; 有所變動**

A number, price, rate, or situation can also **budge** when it changes even slightly.

Practice 6

> “The price has hardly **budded** all year.”

「價格整年幾乎都**沒有變動**。」

Practice 7

> “Despite the exercise, the number on the scale barely **budded**.”

「儘管做了運動，磅秤上的數字幾乎**沒有變化**。」

****budge = 數量、價格、比率或情況出現哪怕很小的變化****

For strict database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 under the broader figurative concept:

> ****move away from an existing state or position****

The Manual tells us not to split merely because the “thing moving” changes from an opinion to a price or number when the underlying semantic image remains the same.

4. ****budge something = make something move (及物) — 移動 ; 挪動****

Although ****budge**** is very often intransitive, it can also be transitive.

Practice 8

> “We could not ****budge**** the table.”

「我們怎樣也****搬不動****那張桌子。」

Practice 9

> “Even three people could not ****budge**** the rock.”

「就算三個人一起也**移不動**那塊石頭。」

budge something = 使某物從固定的位置移動，即使只移動一點

For core counting, this remains under Meaning 1 rather than becoming a new sense.

Related form: **unbudging**

Unbudging means refusing to move or change.

Practice 10

> “She remained **unbudging** in her decision.”

「她在自己的決定上依然**毫不動搖 / 不肯讓步**。」

Practice 11

> “His position was completely **unbudging**.”

「他的立場完全**不肯改變**。」

unbudging = 不肯移動或改變立場的

This form is valid but less common than:

* firm

* unmoving

* unwilling to budge

So I would keep it as a lower-priority family extension.

Important distinction: **budge** vs **move**

move

is the very broad neutral verb for changing position.

budge

usually means:

> move even a little, especially when movement is difficult or resisted.

Compare:

> “The chair moved.”

= 椅子移動了。

> “The chair wouldn’t budge.”

= 椅子怎樣也動不了。

So **budge** carries a stronger idea of **resistance**.

Important distinction: **budge** vs **shift**

shift

means move from one position to another and can be neutral.

budge

often emphasizes that even a tiny amount of movement is difficult.

> “Shift the box to the left.”

= 把箱子移向左邊。

> “The box won’t budge.”

= 箱子完全搬不動。

Important distinction: **budge** vs **give in**

For opinions or negotiations:

budge

= change your position even slightly

give in

= stop resisting and accept the other person's demand

So:

> "He finally budged a little."

does not necessarily mean complete surrender.

> "He gave in."

suggests much stronger concession.

Important distinction: **budge vs compromise**

budge

focuses on changing from a fixed position.

compromise

means both sides make concessions to reach agreement.

A person can:

> budge

without reaching:

> a compromise.

Phrasal-verb note

There are informal phrasal uses such as:

* budge up

* budge over

meaning **move slightly to make space**.

Under your operating procedure, these should not be included in the core entry by default because phrasal verbs are normally excluded unless the target sentence requires them.

Family-extension note

The practical family is small:

* **budge**
* **budged**
* **budging**
* **unbudging**

There are no major high-frequency derivational nouns or adjectives comparable to families such as **accept / acceptance / acceptable**.

The main learning value lies in the contrast between:

- * literal physical movement
- * figurative movement from a fixed position or state

The Golden Manual explicitly says that when a word family is genuinely small, we should say so rather than mechanically inventing family members.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
budge — physical movement	從固定位置稍微移動，尤其指原本很難移動的東西終於動了一點
budge — change position/opinion	原本堅持某個立場、決定或要求，之後稍微改變或讓步
budge — amount/price changes	數字、價格、比率或情況從原有狀態出現些微變化；屬於 figurative movement 義
budge something	使某物從固定位置移動，即使只移動一點
unbudging	不肯移動、改變立場或讓步的；較低頻

For your original sentence

> "...some of the screws would not **budge** ..."

The exact meaning is:

budge = 從原本卡住 / 固定的位置移動哪怕一點

Because the screws were stuck:

> **would not budge**

= **怎樣也扭不動 / 完全紋絲不動**

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **budge**:

1. **physically move, especially a small amount against resistance**
2. **figuratively change from a fixed opinion, position, amount, or state**

I would merge **prices/numbers won't budge** into #2, merge transitive **budge something** into #1, and keep **unbudging** as a lower-priority family extension.